

Local Indexing enables you to control how GD indexes your local computer. These are: the ability to specify what documents should be indexed, the ability to add indexing plug ins for document types not natively supported by GD, the ability to add networked folders and non-fixed drives, limit searching on specified drives and folders, encrypting the GD index, disabling indexing of new items, and removing deleted items from the index.

Google Account Features enables you to control whether Gmail is indexed as part of GD index data, whether the content and settings information for gadgets are saved on Google's GD servers and made available to your other computers, and whether GD should index and make searchable your documents and Web pages across all your computers. If you have multiple computers (for example, a PC at work and another at home and a laptop while you're on the move), you can install GD and share the index information between all of them.

Display enables you to configure how GD should display the Search box, the Quick Search box, what the default search type is, whether the Gadgets button should be displayed on the taskbar, the behaviour of the Quick Find feature, how many results to show per page, and whether desktop results should be shown when you search the Web.

Other specifies whether you give GD permission to send your private data to Google's servers so as to personalise your experience with Sidebar gadgets such as the News gadget, and to send non-personal usage data to help improve GD.

Depending on how much data you have on your computer and in your Gmail account, the indexing can take several hours. Indexing happens in the background when the computer is idle for more than 30 seconds. However, you can speed up indexing and force Google Desktop to index continuously by clicking on the Index Now link on the GD homepage. Be warned that this will have an impact on your system's performance, as GD indexing will take up quite a bit of processing power.

7.10.2 Searching with Google Desktop

Searching with GD is similar to searching Google. Type in the search term and hit the [Enter] key to get relevant results that match your keywords. To do this, you need to

access GD first. This can be done in a number of ways. Depending on how you have set up its appearance, GD may be displayed as a Sidebar, a Deskbar, a floating Deskbar, or it may be completely hidden, in which case you would double-click the GD icon to open the GD homepage in a browser. You may have also configured the Quick Search box (via the **Preferences > Display** page) which is activated by pressing the [Ctrl] key twice.

The results displayed are sorted on the basis of date by default; they can also be sorted on the basis of relevance. The search results can be narrowed down to only show specific types of documents like e-mail, files, Web history, and chats. If you have allowed searching across computers, GD also displays results from your other computers.

Also, with GD installed and when searching the Web with Google, any relevant desktop search results are displayed along with the Web search results, if you have chosen this to happen, as mentioned above.



Your Desktop Search results integrate with Web results



The GD Timeline View